

MAKE YOUR EMPLOYEES Hate You



...if they don't already! Get them to stop wasting time...and be merciless about it!

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A quick quiz:

1. You're watching *Star Wars Episode 6 (Return Of The Jedi)*. Darth Vader (Anakin Skywalker) has just thrown the evil emperor into that bottomless pit. You...

- a) Shed a tear. You actually liked that crazy old coot.
- b) Rejoice. The dark side of the Force is vanquished.

2. You're watching the TV serial *The Office*.

- a) You cannot understand what all the fuss is about, and all the jokes are terrible. That poor boss chap...
- b) It's your favourite show. You swear there's one of each character of the series in your office.

If you answered "b" to both, be afraid. Be very afraid. If "a" is what you went with both times... Warning: this article could cause serious friction burns from vigorously rubbing your hands together in glee, and make you burst into hysterical laughter. Yes, you guessed it. You're that dreaded and much-hated creature called *The Boss*, whom no one understands. You're the *Gollum* of Middle Earth, ugly, disgusting but very much necessary if *Frodo* is to ever find his way.

OK, enough of the silly analogies; you're a boss, and you have a job. It's not pleasant, but it has to be done. You just have to prevent your employees from running amok. As of this century, however, employees are much more tech-savvy. They're always punctual, they're always sitting quietly in their little cubicles, and even avoid the regular goofing-off waterholes. To the untrained eye, they're hard at work, silently toiling away at their desks. Your latest sales figures and financial reports tell you otherwise.

The Internet is one of the banes of every boss' existence. Sure it's informative, and even a necessary enabler for a lot of existing business models, but it's also the world's favourite goofing-off spot. A couple of videos on YouTube, scrapping friends on Orkut, checking useless forwards sent by

friends / colleagues, IM-ing all day, and even visiting adult dating and content sites can reduce the amount of productive time spent in office per employee to a fraction of what's expected.

Boss Speak

None of the people we spoke to for this article wished to be named, whether boss or minion. No one wanted to ruin the work relationships they have, and we understand that. We will quote them, however, quite shamelessly, but will not include their names.

The CEO of a BPO said, "I hate IMs. I have never seen a worse technology invention. Nothing hampers productivity as much as MSN and Yahoo! Messenger. We blocked those chat protocols, and then our employees started using browser-based services like www.e-messenger.net. It was like an addiction we had to break. Now after we've blocked all the browser-based messenger sites, they're using local chat applications such as IP Messenger to waste time chatting with the person in the next bay!"

A system admin of an e-learning company

